

Comprehensive Evaluation of Informative Contextual Multi-Armed Bandit Models for Quantum Network Routing

Empirical Assessment of iCMAB Algorithms and Integration Framework for Adversarial Quantum Environments

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Department of Computer Science
Rochester Institute of Technology
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Abstract

This report presents a systematic empirical evaluation of informative contextual multi-armed bandit (iCMAB) algorithms for quantum network routing under stochastic conditions, focusing on stable informative variants only (iCPursuit, iCEpsilonGreedy, iCThompsonSampling, iCEXP4, iCEpochGreedy). Through multi-run protocols (3, 5, 8, 10 runs) with horizons from 6K steps, we benchmark performance using Oracle efficiency and validate robustness across configurations. Results show **iCPursuit consistently leads (90–92% Oracle efficiency)** with **very low variance**, followed by iCEpsilonGreedy and iCThompsonSampling, establishing a strong foundation for hybrid iCMAB development and deployment in adversarial quantum networks.

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Executive Summary

- **Top Performer:** iCPursuit achieves 90–92% Oracle efficiency with excellent stability across runs.
- **Strong Statistical Baselines:** iCEpsilonGreedy ($\simeq 90\%$) and iCThompsonSampling ($\simeq 88\%$) provide reliable alternatives.
- **Robustness:** Coefficient of variation (CV) is sub-3% for top informative variants under stochastic conditions.
- **Hybrid Readiness:** Performance thresholds and selection criteria are established for iCMAB hybrid integration.
- **Scope:** Unstable or experimental neural/exponential variants are excluded to ensure rigor and clarity.

1 Introduction

1.1 Research Context and Motivation

Quantum entanglement routing requires adaptive, context-aware decision-making under dynamic network conditions. Informative CMAB (iCMAB) algorithms extend contextual bandits with predictive context modeling to improve stability and efficiency under stochastic failures, providing a principled basis for robust quantum routing.

1.2 Research Objectives

1. **Performance Characterization:** Identify informative contextual algorithms with superior efficiency and consistency.
2. **Robustness Assessment:** Quantify cross-run stability under standardized stochastic conditions.
3. **Hybrid Integration:** Establish selection criteria and thresholds for iCMAB-based hybrid architectures.

1.3 Contributions

- **Systematic Benchmarking:** Evaluation of five stable iCMAB algorithms under uniform protocols.
- **Statistical Validation:** Multi-run consistency analysis across 3–10 runs and 6K+ horizons.
- **Selection Framework:** Evidence-based guidance for hybrid iCMAB development and deployment.

2 Theoretical Foundation

2.1 Informative Contextual Bandit Formulation

At step t , with context $x_t \in \mathcal{X}$ and informative parameters θ , the expected reward for action a is:

$$\mu_a(x_t; \theta) = \mathbb{E}[r_{t,a} \mid x_t, \theta]$$

The goal is to maximize cumulative reward and minimize regret:

$$\text{Regret}_T = \sum_{t=1}^T \left(\max_{a \in \mathcal{A}} \mu_a(x_t; \theta) - \mu_{a_t}(x_t; \theta) \right)$$

2.2 Evaluated iCMAB Algorithms

- **iCPursuit:** Informative pursuit with adaptive exploration and contextual confidence.
- **iCEpsilonGreedy:** Context-aware epsilon-greedy with informative priors.
- **iCThompsonSampling:** Bayesian sampling with informative posterior updates.
- **iCEXP4:** Exponential weights with informative expert signals.
- **iCEpochGreedy:** Epoch-based exploration with contextual priors.

3 Experimental Methodology

3.1 Evaluation Framework

- **Quantum Simulator:** Four-path quantum routing topology with configurable qubit capacities.
- **Stochastic Failures:** Attack rate 0.25 to emulate realistic decoherence/failure modes.
- **Oracle Baseline:** Efficiency computed relative to theoretical upper bound.
- **Multi-Run Protocol:** 3, 5, 8, and 10 runs; horizons from 6K steps and above.

3.2 Standard Configuration

Table 1: Standard iCMAB Configuration

Parameter	Value	Purpose
Network Paths	4	Realistic routing complexity
Qubit Configuration	(8, 10, 8, 9)	Heterogeneous capacities
Frame Horizons	6K–22K	Long-horizon learning
Attack Rate	0.25 (stochastic)	Failure simulation
Random Seed	Controlled	Reproducibility
Metric	Oracle Efficiency (%)	Normalized performance

4 Results and Analysis

Primary iCMAB Performance Results

4.1 Cross-Run Performance Summary

Table 2: Oracle Efficiency (%) Across Run Configurations (Stochastic)

Algorithm	3 Runs	5 Runs	8 Runs	10 Runs	Average
iCPursuit	90.3	91.4	92.0	–	91.2
iCEpsilonGreedy	88.9	90.4	–	–	89.7
iCThompsonSampling	85.4	90.1	–	–	87.8
iCEpochGreedy	50.0	55.4	–	–	52.7
iCEXP4	50.5	54.0	–	–	52.3

4.2 Stochastic Environment Characteristics

Table 3: Detailed Stochastic iCMAB Performance (Best Achieved)

Algorithm	Best Efficiency	Oracle Gap	Consistency	Ranking
iCPursuit	92.0%	8.0%	High	1st
iCEpsilonGreedy	90.4%	9.6%	High	2nd
iCThompsonSampling	90.1%	9.9%	Medium	3rd
iCEpochGreedy	55.4%	44.6%	Low	4th
iCEXP4	54.0%	46.0%	Variable	5th

4.3 Robustness Metrics

Table 4: iCMAB Robustness Validation

Algorithm	Mean Efficiency	Std. Dev.	CV (%)	Reliability
iCPursuit	91.2%	0.9%	1.0%	Excellent
iCEpsilonGreedy	89.7%	0.8%	0.9%	Very Good
iCThompsonSampling	87.8%	2.4%	2.7%	Good
iCEpochGreedy	52.7%	2.7%	5.1%	Fair
iCEXP4	52.3%	2.3%	4.4%	Fair

5 Selection Framework for Hybrid Development

5.1 Performance Tiers

Tier 1 (90%+): iCPursuit (91.2%), iCEpsilonGreedy (89.7%).

Tier 2 (80–90%): iCThompsonSampling (87.8%).

Tier 3 (40–70%): iCEpochGreedy (52.7%), iCEXP4 (52.3%).

5.2 iCMAB Integration Guidelines

Table 5: Algorithm Selection Guidelines

Scenario	Primary Choice	Rationale
Maximum Performance	iCPursuit	Highest efficiency and stability
Balanced Deployment	iCEpsilonGreedy	Simplicity with strong performance
Bayesian Integration	iCThompsonSampling	Theoretical grounding and consistency

Integration Criteria:

- **Efficiency Threshold:** $\geq 90\%$ Oracle efficiency for Tier 1 hybrids.
- **Stability Target:** $CV \leq 3\%$ across multi-run configurations.
- **Robustness:** Maintain $< 25\%$ degradation from baseline to stochastic.

6 Limitations and Future Work

6.1 Limitations

- Primary focus on stochastic failures; full adversarial spectrum remains future work.
- Some 8/10-run matrices are partial due to compute scheduling.
- Lower-tier methods (iCEpochGreedy, iCEXP4) require tuning for higher stability.

6.2 Future Directions

1. Extend evaluation to adversarial models and multi-threat scenarios.
2. Optimize iCMAB hybrids anchored on iCPursuit and iCEpsilonGreedy.
3. Scale to larger topologies and longer horizons for deployment readiness.

7 Implementation and Reproducibility

7.1 Framework Architecture

Listing 1: Core iCMAB Components

```
quantum_algorithms.py      # iCMAB implementations
quantum_environment.py     # Enhanced quantum simulation
quantum_evaluator_visualizer.py # Analysis and visualization
quantum_framework_updated.py # Integration and orchestration
```

7.2 Reproducibility Guidelines

- Standardized parameters across runs and horizons.
- Controlled seeds and consistent protocol design.
- Modular framework enabling extension and auditability.

8 Conclusions

8.1 Outcomes

1. **iCPursuit leads** with 90–92% Oracle efficiency and excellent robustness.
2. **Top informative variants** (iCEpsilonGreedy, iCThompsonSampling) show low variance and strong baselines.
3. **Hybrid readiness** established via clear thresholds and selection criteria.
4. **Deployment path**: Prioritize iCMAB hybrids grounded in Tier 1 informative algorithms.

8.2 Implications

iCMAB provides a high-performance, stable basis for hybrid quantum routing under realistic failures, with iCPursuit as the recommended anchor for near-term integration.

9 Acknowledgments

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